

Red junglefowl

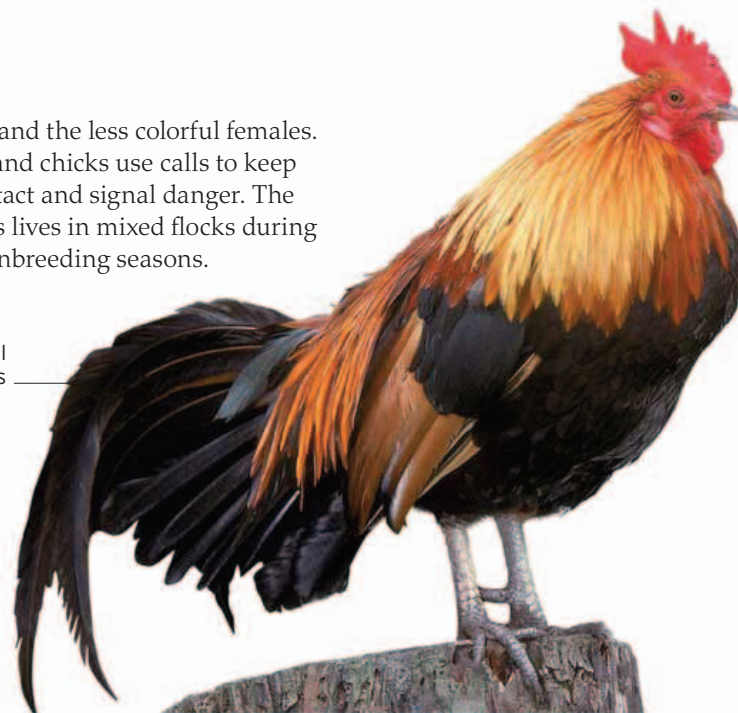
Gallus gallus

- ↔ 32 in (80 cm)
- 📍 S. and SE. Asia
- ⊗ Common

Native to the tropical forests of southern Asia, the red junglefowl was first raised in captivity at least 5,000 years ago, to become the ancestor of the domestic chicken. In spring—the breeding season—the male looks much like many farmyard cockerels, with a golden cape, and a fleshy comb and red wattles on his head. He also performs the same “cock-a-doodle-doo” when displaying to rival

males and the less colorful females. Hens and chicks use calls to keep in contact and signal danger. The species lives in mixed flocks during the nonbreeding seasons.

long tail feathers



Other species

- **Arabian partridge**
Alectoris melanoccephala » p253
- **Golden pheasant**
Chrysolophus pictus » p277
- **Greater sage-grouse**
Centrocercus urophasianus » p50
- **Helmeted guineafowl**
Numida meleagris » p207
- **Indian peafowl**
Pavo cristatus » p271
- **Ptarmigan**
Lagopus muta » p161
- **Western capercaillie**
Tetrao urogallus » p145

Waterfowl

Order Anseriformes

Black swan

Cygnus atratus

- ↔ 4–5 ft (1.2–1.5 m)
- 📍 Australia (including Tasmania), New Zealand
- ⊗ Common

With its sinuous neck and elegant appearance, this is a typical swan. Its plumage is black, aside from white flight feathers that are hidden when its wings are folded; it has a uniquely bright red bill with a white bar near the tip. It feeds on aquatic plants, often in large groups.

Common teal

Anas crecca

- ↔ 14–15 in (36–38 cm)
- 📍 North America, Europe (including Iceland), Asia, N. to C. Africa
- ⊗ Common

Much smaller than most wild ducks, the teal is widespread on lakes and wetlands throughout Eurasia, gathering in large flocks in winter. In the breeding season, the male develops a chestnut head, with metallic green around the eyes, and a speckled gray body with a bright green wing patch. The female is mainly brown but has the same green wing patch. The common teal eats seeds in winter and small animals in summer.

Canada goose

Branta canadensis

- ↔ 22–39 in (55–100 cm)
- 📍 North America, N. Europe, NE. Asia, New Zealand
- ⊗ Common

This dark, black-necked goose is native to North America, but has been introduced to other regions where its adaptability has enabled it to thrive in a wide range of habitats, from remote wetlands to urban parks. It lives in flocks, eating mainly grasses and aquatic plants. In its native range, it migrates north to breed and returns south for the winter, flying

in V-formations with loud honking calls. Males and females of this species tend to mate for life, and pairs remain together year round.

Other species

- **King eider**
Somateria spectabilis » p137
- **Mandarin duck**
Aix galericulata » p290
- **Mute swan**
Cygnus olor » p148
- **Plumed whistling-duck**
Dendrocygna eytoni » p322
- **Snow goose**
Chen caerulescens » p33

Penguins

Order Sphenisciformes

Macaroni penguin

Eudyptes chrysolophus

- ↔ 28 in (71 cm)
- 📍 S. Chile, South Atlantic, S. Indian Ocean
- ⊗ Vulnerable

The macaroni penguin is distinguished by its conspicuous crest of golden plumes and its large, orange-brown bill. Like all

penguins, it hunts at sea, but forms large breeding colonies on the Antarctic Peninsula and the sub-Antarctic islands to the south of Africa and South America. Noisy and aggressive, it competes for breeding territory with loud, braying calls. Females lay two eggs, and both sexes share incubation duties—although, unlike in other penguin species, females take the first shift.

Chinstrap penguin

Pygoscelis antarctica

- ↔ 28–30 in (71–76 cm)
- 📍 Circumpolar around Antarctica
- ⊗ Common



Named for the black line around its chin, this penguin feeds mainly on swarming, shrimplike krill in the waters around the Antarctic peninsula. It lives at sea most of the year, resting on the floating pack ice that covers the Southern Ocean in winter. In spring, the chinstrap penguin makes its way to dense colonies on ice-free shores, laying two eggs in nests made of small stones and feathers.

Other species

- **Adelie penguin**
Pygoscelis adeliae » p372
- **Emperor penguin**
Aptenodytes forsteri » pp374–75
- **Galapagos penguin**
Spheniscus mendiculus » p124
- **Rockhopper penguin**
Eudyptes chrysocome » p368